

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

In this lesson, we explore how to restrict the mobility of the stronger side's king when defending against a pawn. The position illustrates how the defender can create a fortress by placing the king in front of the pawn or on key squares to prevent the opponent's king from advancing. This lesson highlights the strategic importance of king positioning in pawn endgames.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White seeks to restrict the black king's movement and promote the pawn, while Black aims to maintain a defensive position and prevent promotion.

STRATEGY

Restrict the mobility of the stronger side's king by placing the defending king in front of the pawn or on key squares. This creates a fortress that prevents the opponent's king from advancing and allows for successful pawn promotion.

MOVES

First, move your king to c1 to prevent the black king from advancing. If the black king moves to a2, you can advance the pawn. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kc1 Kb2 2. Rb8+ Ka3 3. Kc2 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson discusses the strategic importance of king positioning in pawn endgames and how to create a fortress to restrict the opponent's king's movement.